

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

Finding reasoning paths :

- 1 . Chronic sadness and hope lessness -> Major depressive disorder
- 2 . Worsening suicidal ide ations -> Major depressive disorder with psychotic features
- 3 . Chronic low energy and concentration issues -> Generalized anxiety disorder or depressive disorder
- 4 . Past history of guilt and blame -> Post-tra umatic stress disorder (PTSD) or depression

Reasoning Process :

- 1 . The patient describes feeling sad for as long as he can remember , which suggests a long-term pattern of sadness . This is a hallmark of depression .
- 2 . He also mentions feeling hopeless and stating that if something terrible can happen , it usually will . This align s with the feeling of pessim ism and decreased life satisfaction often seen in major depressive disorder .
- 3 . The worsening of suicidal ide ations is a significant red flag . While this can occur in depression , it is particularly concerning in the context of psychotic features , which might suggest a mixed depressive and psychotic disorder .
- 4 . Chronic low energy and concentration issues are common in depression , especially when combined with increased hope lessness and suicidal ide ations .
- 5 . The patient's job-related responsibilities indicate that his functioning is not significantly impaired , which suggests that while he may have depression , it is not severe enough to cause major occupational dysfunction .

Conclusion :

The patient's symptoms are consistent with major depressive disorder , particularly with psychotic features . The worsening suicidal ide ations and guilt from past problems further support this diagnosis . While the condition may have developed from a chronic pattern of sadness , the current presentation suggests a more acute phase of depression , possibly with psychotic features .

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< answer >

The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis .

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